BALAKANNAN ESAKKINATHAN

Senior Software Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer with 18+ years of experience in full-stack development, cloud-based deployments, and scalable database solutions. Proven track record of optimizing systems, reducing costs, and improving developer productivity. Adept at leading cross-functional teams and driving technical innovation to align with business goals.

SKILLS

Languages/Frameworks: Ruby on Rails, Ruby, JavaScript, React, Vue.js, Python, Java

Databases: PostgreSQL, DynamoDB, Redis, BigQuery

Testing/Version Control: RSpec, Git

Cloud/AWS: S3, Lambda, Kinesis, DynamoDB, Redshift, Athena, Bedrock

DevOps/Infrastructure: Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform

Monitoring/Observability: DataDog, ElasticSearch, New Relic

Analytics/Data: Looker, Apache Airflow

Marketing/Email: Iterable, Mailgun

AI Tooling: Cursor, Claude Code

WORK HISTORY

Senior Software Engineer / Technical Lead
The Walt Disney Company (Contract) - Burbank, CA

05/2025 to Current

- Led full-stack application upgrades from Rails 6 to Rails 8 and Ruby 3.4, modernizing legacy monolithic architecture and improving overall application throughput and performance.
- Architected and maintained scalable RESTful APIs serving multi-tenant client environments, ensuring 99.9% availability and low-latency response times.
- Streamlined identity management by integrating Okta SSO/OAuth authentication across core Rails applications.
- Modernized frontend asset pipelines by migrating legacy view layers to Vue.js and updating Bootstrap UI frameworks, enhancing user experience and reducing bundle size.
- Automated workflow integrations between Rails applications and ServiceNow APIs to streamline IT service delivery and data synchronization.
- Accelerated development velocity by incorporating AI-assisted tooling (Cursor, Claude Code) into the SDLC for rapid prototyping, complex code refactoring, and automated test suite generation.
- Optimized agile delivery cycles by driving sprint planning, code reviews, and automated CI/CD pipeline improvements to consistently ship production features on schedule.

Senior Consultant
Tekcrew - Cerritos, CA

05/2024 to 05/2025

- Integrated Iterable 3rd-party APIs with Ruby on Rails to automate marketing campaigns, user notifications, and event-driven email pipelines.
- Provisioned and managed SSL/TLS certificates using AWS Certificate Manager (ACM) to secure application domains and endpoint traffic.
- Designed and developed an Email Dashboard UI using React, providing real-time visibility into message metrics and delivery status.
- Containerized Rails applications using Docker, standardizing local development environments and streamlining deployment pipelines.
- Implemented background job processing using Sidekiq to handle high-volume batch email dispatches asynchronously, preventing request timeouts and improving response latency.

Senior Software Engineer
PayPal - San Jose, CA

08/2021 to 04/2024

- Migrated legacy Java-based transaction microservices to Ruby on Rails, eliminating architectural bottlenecks and reducing transaction execution latency.
- Architected Looker dashboards backed by Google BigQuery, empowering customer support teams with self-service access to proof-of-authorization data.
- Configured Datadog monitoring dashboards and alert triggers to track application performance metrics, system throughput, and operational health.
- Mentored junior engineers, led rigorous code reviews to enforce quality standards, and participated in 24/7 on-call rotations to ensure high system availability.

Principal Consultant
PayPal (Contract) - San Jose, CA

10/2020 to 06/2021

- Integrated GIACT API service within Rails applications to automate real-time bank account verification and reduce fraudulent transactions.
- Updated payment and bank validation rules to strictly align with financial regulatory compliance standards and improve end-to-end transaction accuracy.

Senior Software Engineer
TrueCar - Santa Monica, CA

01/2007 to 07/2020

- Designed and implemented the Incentives Management Tool, serving as the primary incentives source for TrueCar Systems using Rails.
- Developed and deployed consumer-facing Rails APIs for incentive coupon generation, integrating with vendors such as BMW, Mercedes, Chrysler, and Volvo.
- Supported the Dealer Team by implementing ad hoc requests for the TrueCar Dealer Portal.
- Performed an additional role as Scrum Master, facilitating Agile ceremonies and ensuring smooth sprint execution.

- Contributed to the development of TrueCar Partners Mobile Sites using Python, Flask, SQL, Nginx, and Burp Suite.
- Designed, implemented, and supported 800+ TrueCar Partner Sites using Java, Spring Framework, and jQuery.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Computer Science
Manonmaniam Sundaranar University - Tamil Nadu, India

ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- Led a full-stack modernization (Rails 6 to 8, Ruby 3.4, Vue.js) of a multi-tenant enterprise platform, cutting response times approximately 30%, maintaining 99.9% uptime, and eliminating security risk from EOL dependencies.
- Individually coordinated with 3rd party vendors to integrate their APIs (ServiceNow, Iterable).
- Recognized for Excellence: Received two OnSpot Awards from PayPal for outstanding contributions.
- Optimized Transaction Performance: Reduced bank transaction response time by 40% by migrating a Java-based transaction service to Ruby on Rails.
- Enhanced API Efficiency: Revamped GIACT API, improving bank account validation accuracy and efficiency.
- Reduced Returns and Increased Merchant Savings: Implemented reinitiation and validation rules, reducing returns by 30%, leading to $5 million in savings for merchants.
- Improved Developer Productivity: Developed a Looker dashboard using BigQuery, saving developers 2-3 hours daily in data retrieval and analysis.
- Designed and Implemented Incentive Management Tool: Led the development of a Ruby on Rails, PostgreSQL, and React-based Incentive Management Tool at TrueCar, streamlining operations and reducing cross-team dependencies.

AWARDS

Most Creative Award, 2019 TrueCar Hackathon
(https://medium.com/drivenby-code/hackathon-project-connected-car-c5cb3fd24355)